

Gautam Velpula

Vice President, Enterprise Architecture

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Dear Hiring Team,

The brief for this role — defining the enterprise architecture vision for a global, multi-brand hospitality organization, and aligning brand, guest experience, property operations, and corporate functions on a common technology foundation — describes the shape of the work I have been doing for the past four years, and would be glad to do at IHG's scale. As an Atlanta-based leader, I would also welcome being in the office and close to the teams doing the work.

At GoTo Foods I serve as the single Enterprise Architecture authority across a multi-brand consumer business spanning digital, loyalty, commerce, marketing technology, payments, and data. I established the frameworks, standards, and review processes that govern architecture across the business, application, data, and infrastructure domains, and I built a portfolio roadmap that retired redundant systems and consolidated seven independent brand apps and websites onto a unified digital platform. The outcome — roughly 40% faster time-to-market and 30% better uptime — came less from any single technology choice than from giving product and engineering reusable, governed paths to delivery. That balance of long-term vision with near-term delivery is the core of what your role is asking for.

The hospitality problem set maps closely to what I already govern. My multi-brand estate runs on the same building blocks your properties do — loyalty, POS, digital channels, payments, and a central customer data model — integrated through an API-first, event-driven microservices architecture with standardized middleware patterns so data flows cleanly across brands and third-party partners. I established the enterprise data architecture and governance that aligns our Martech and CDP platforms to enable accurate analytics, attribution, and AI-driven personalization, and I direct the vendor and SaaS selection and governance that keeps a large third-party portfolio architecturally consistent. My cloud modernization background spans all three major providers, including a multi-year AWS-to-GCP migration I led at Slalom for a leading point-of-sale provider and a target-state assessment of a legacy AWS payments platform for one of the largest U.S. eCommerce companies.

Over the last 18 months I have been particularly focused on the transformation your job description calls out directly: leading enterprise AI through a forward-deployed architecture model. I chair the enterprise AI Working Group that reviews and approves every AI initiative company-wide, and I embed architects alongside product and engineering teams to adopt GenAI and Agentic AI safely — defining the patterns, guardrails, and DevSecOps standards that let those teams build with confidence rather than waiting on a central bottleneck. That is exactly the model needed to turn AI into differentiated guest experiences at enterprise scale.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can help define IHG's enterprise architecture vision, govern its evolution across brands and domains, and accelerate the safe, reusable adoption of AI across the guest journey.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Gautam Velpula